

Document 14: Coronary Heart Disease - Risk and Prevention

Coronary heart disease (CHD) occurs when the coronary arteries become narrowed or blocked, usually due to atherosclerosis (buildup of fatty deposits). This reduces blood flow to the heart muscle, leading to chest pain (angina), heart attacks, and heart failure. Major risk factors include hypertension, high cholesterol, smoking, diabetes, obesity, and physical inactivity. Prevention strategies involve lifestyle changes such as a heart-healthy diet, regular exercise, smoking cessation, and controlling blood pressure and cholesterol levels. Medications and surgical interventions may be necessary for high-risk individuals.